Contractor Leads SEO work report

5 November 2026 · https://www.contractorleads.us · Weeks 1 and 2 of the SEO page-building plan · Branch claude/quirky-thompson-65u09b, commit 712e7a0 (goes live when merged to master)

10	350	460	967
new commercial landing pages	state pages rebuilt on real facts	sitemap pages checked, 0 problems	structured-data blocks, 0 errors

Most important finding

The 350 state pages showed statistics generated from the trade and state name, not real data: business counts, "% with no website", ratings and sample leads. One of these figures also appeared in Google's search results. This is a likely reason Google crawled these pages but chose not to index them. All invented figures were removed and the pages were rebuilt on real, checkable state facts.

1. State pages (350): rebuilt on real facts

	Before	After
Data	Hash-generated business counts, no-website %, ratings, sample leads	Census division, 4 real neighbouring states, climate exposures, solar resource, growth, housing age, real top 5 cities
Content	Same template with the state name swapped	Quick answer, trade-specific demand drivers, when to pitch, recommended angle, 6 visible FAQs
Meta description	Stated an invented percentage	Only true statements, under 155 characters
Internal links	10 states from the same region	The 4 neighbouring states (as the plan requires), the trade hub and the full state list
Structured data	FAQ built on invented numbers	FAQPage matching the visible FAQs, plus breadcrumbs

Climate exposures used: hail belt, hurricane coast, coastal storms, tornado regions, wildfire West, cold winters and long cooling seasons. Every neighbour list was checked against real borders; Alaska, Hawaii and states with fewer than four borders use the nearest states and are labelled "neighbouring and nearby".

2. Other week 1 fixes

Page / area	What changed
Trade pages (18), incl. /industries/solar	Removed identical made-up stat cards ("~28% no website", "~12% running Meta ads"). Added trade-specific quick answers, what owners buy, when they buy and 5 FAQs for the 7 main trades. Added Service schema.
/pricing	Keyword H1 ("Contractor Leads pricing: plans from $19.99"), quick answer, cost-per-lead table calculated from live plan prices, 2 new FAQs, links to cost benchmarks, alternatives and the email finder.
Homepage	58-word "What are contractor leads?" quick answer, proof strip of real product facts, route for contractors seeking homeowner jobs, and a 16-link "Most searched" block. H1 already contains "contractor leads".
Sitemap dates	Each page now reports its own last-changed date instead of one site-wide date.
Old /trades/ URLs	Confirmed permanent (301) redirects to /industries/; no internal links point to /trades/.

Page / area	What changed
Stricter limits	16 older pages fixed to the plan's standard: titles under 60 and descriptions under 155 characters.
Mobile	Homepage tour close button enlarged so it is easy to tap.

3. Week 2: 10 new commercial landing pages

Pages where searchers are contractors looking for homeowner jobs are written as honest, neutral guides that state Contractor Leads does not sell homeowner leads (as agreed).

URL	Target keyword	Type	Words	Links in
/contractor-email-finder	contractor email finder	Product page	726	457
/exclusive-contractor-leads	exclusive contractor leads	Honest guide	799	15
/homeowner-leads	homeowner leads	Honest guide	661	5
/storm-damage-leads	storm damage leads	Honest guide	662	3
/new-construction-leads	new construction leads	Honest guide	695	4
/commercial-contractor-leads	commercial contractor leads	Honest guide	772	4
/contractor-lead-tracking	lead tracking for contractors	Guide	694	5
/contractor-lead-management	contractor lead management	Guide	676	4
/contractor-crm	contractor crm	Guide	695	4
/sms-marketing-for-contractors	sms marketing for contractors	Guide	711	3

Upgraded existing pages: **/contractor-lead-generation-software** and **/google-maps-scraper** (quick answers, Service schema, FAQ answers expanded to 40+ words, keyword in the first paragraph).

Page standard (checked automatically on every new page)

Rule from the plan	Result
Primary keyword in title (<60), H1, first paragraph, description (<155)	Pass, all 10
Quick answer of 40 to 60 words under the hero	Pass (49 to 54 words)
600 to 1,500 words written for that page only	Pass (661 to 799 words)
5 to 6 FAQs, each 40 to 70 words	Pass
Proof block	Product facts (see actions: real client results needed)
Schema: breadcrumbs, Service or WebPage, FAQPage	Pass, validated
3+ internal links in and 3+ out	Pass (3 to 457 in, 6 out)
No two pages share a primary keyword	Pass across all pages and blog posts

4. Internal linking

- Comparison pages now link to /exclusive-contractor-leads, pricing, the email finder and the next 2 to 3 comparisons in rotation, so every comparison page receives links.
- State pages link to their 4 neighbouring states, the trade hub and the full state list.
- Homepage "Most searched" block links 16 key pages.

- Footer adds the contractor email finder and the partner sites RankEmpire (SEO for contractors) and Funnels That Print.
- llms.txt lists all 10 new pages for AI search tools.

5. Verification (local production build, all 460 sitemap pages)

Check	Result
SEO crawl: status, titles <60, descriptions <155, canonicals, one H1, broken links, duplicates, orphans, social tags	0 problems
Structured-data validator: required fields, breadcrumbs, FAQ text visible on page, listed URLs live	0 problems (967 blocks)
Fake ratings or reviews in structured data	None
Mobile (390 px): horizontal scroll, H1 count, tap targets, page errors	Pass on all pages tested
Type check, lint and production build	Pass

6. Actions needed from you

- **Merge the pull request**, then tell us so the new pages can be submitted to IndexNow.
- **Google Search Console:** delete the broken /ssitemap.xml, run URL Inspection on the state pages, and request indexing for the 10 new pages.
- **Real client results** (case studies, booked calls, ROAS) for the proof blocks; only product facts are shown today.
- **Permit volumes and lead counts per state** need a real data source. Allowing US Census Bureau access in the environment's network settings would let us add official permit data.
- **Connect Search Console to OpenSEO** so progress can be measured against the plan's week-8 targets.

7. Next, per the plan's schedule

Week	Work
Week 3	10 alternatives and comparison pages (HomeAdvisor, Angi, Thumbtack, Porch, Networx, ZoomInfo, Seamless.AI, BuildZoom, Angi vs HomeAdvisor, exclusive vs shared), as honest guides
Week 4	5 cost and benchmark pages plus 5 free calculator tools
Weeks 5 and 6	12 blog posts, then a Search Console review and retitling

Rankings cannot be guaranteed; Google decides them, and new pages usually take a few weeks to move. This report covers technical correctness, content and linking, which were verified before delivery.